

Navigation Property in Entity Framework Core

Introduction

Navigation properties are special properties in Entity Framework Core that allow entities to reference related entities. They are used to represent relationships between tables in an object-oriented way.

Types of Navigation Properties

Reference Navigation Property represents a single related entity such as Product to Category. Collection Navigation Property represents multiple related entities such as Category to Products.

One-to-Many Relationship

In a one-to-many relationship, one entity can be related to multiple entities. For example, one Category can contain many Products.

Many-to-Many Relationship

Many-to-many relationships are implemented using a junction table such as OrderDetail or Loan. This table connects records between two entities.

Benefits of Navigation Properties

Navigation properties improve code readability, simplify querying related data, and help Entity Framework automatically detect relationships.

Conclusion

Navigation properties are essential in EF Core because they provide an easier way to manage and access related data using C# classes.